# VICTORY 2026

HISTORY

## QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT

Lecture – 02

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# Topics *to be covered*

1. QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT
2. Government's Measures
3. Significance of Quit India
4.



# Swagat Hai Cheems Gang Ka



# QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT

Location
Gowalia Tank Maidan

1. The All-India Congress Committee met at Bombay on August 8, 1942 and passed the Quit India Resolution adopted at Wardha in July 1942.

2. The Congress proposed to start a non-violent mass struggle under Gandhiji's leadership if this demand of immediate and complete independence was not conceded by the British.

3. In his speech before the All India Congress Committee, Gandhiji declared that it was a decision "To Do or Die".

# QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT

1. Before the Congress could start the movement, the Government responded

2. Early in the morning of August 9, Gandhiji and other Congress leaders were arrested and taken to unknown destinations and the Congress was once again declared illegal.

1. All over the country there were strikes and demonstrations which were lathi-charged and fired upon.

2. People attacked the symbols of British authority-the police stations, post offices, railway stations, etc. National flags were hoisted on public buildings in defiance of the police.

3. British authority disappeared in parts of Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, West Bengal, Odisha, Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu and Maharashtra.

4. In some areas such as Ballia in Eastern U.P., Tamluk in Midnapore district of West Bengal and Satara district of Maharashtra, the nationalists set up parallel governments.

1. Achyutrao Patwardhan, Jai Prakash Narayan, Ram Manohar Lohia, Aruna Asaf Ali and Nana Patil were among the prominent leaders of the underground movement.

2. They set up a Central Directorate at Mumbai. They kept the movement alive despite the government's repressive measures.

3. The movement also saw the active participation of women such as Matangini Hazra in Bengal, Kanaklata Barua in Assam and Rama Devi in Odisha.

4. Aruna Asaf Ali hoisted the Indian National flag at the Gowalia Tank ground, Mumbai on August 9, 1942.

5. She, along with Usha Mehta, also broadcast news through an underground radio station.

# GOVERNMENT'S REPRESSIVE MEASURES

1. The government took severe measures to crush the 1942 Movement. The Press was completely banned . The demonstrating crowds were machine-gunned and even bombed from the air.

2. Prisoners were tortured. The police and secret police dominated. Nearly ten thousand people were killed and 60,000 people were arrested by the end of 1942.

# GOVERNMENT'S REPRESSIVE MEASURES

1. The military took over many towns and cities.
2. Rebellious villages had to pay huge sums as fines and the villagers were beaten .
3. India had not witnessed such intense repression since the First War of Independence, 1857.
4. Gandhiji was detained at the Agha Khan Palace in Pune; the other leaders were sent to jail in Ahmednagar Fort. In the end, the government succeeded in crushing the movement.

# SIGNIFICACE OF THE QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT

The Quit India movement made independence of India as the only agenda of the National Movement. The Movement had the following impact:

1. Although the movement was short lived, the people developed greater ability to struggle and sacrifice.

2. It became evident that the British no longer would be able to rule India. The movement signified the mass uprising of the people.

3. People from every state, class, caste, sex and creed participated in the movement.
4. The Quit India Movement strengthened the Congress Socialist Party, and its leader Jai Prakash Narayan became a legendary figure.

# SIGNIFICACE OF THE QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT

- The party continued to function underground.
- After the suppression of the movement, there was hardly any political activity till the Second World War ended.
- As most of the prominent leaders were arrested and jailed, there was an absence of leadership which could guide the people.

- The Quit India Movement also saw efforts by the Indian National Army under Subhas Chandra Bose to work in cooperation with Germany and Japan to bring much awaited independence to the country.



# Summary

Significance of the Movement

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# Homework From VICTORY Module

Briefly discuss the Significance of Quit India Movement. (4)


Thank You